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Comparison of Bayan Sulu to Ferrero

Global:
Bayan Sulu is a Kazakhstan company which has international and export activity [1]. It exports to 14 countries [2]. Ferrero is a worldwide company. It operates in 50+ countries and its products are sold in more than 170 countries [3]. This gap in reach shows up in revenue too: for the fiscal year ended August 31, 2025, Ferrero Group reported consolidated turnover of €19.3 billion (up 4.6% year-on-year) and more than 50,000 employees worldwide [3], while JSC Bayan Sulu reported 2025 revenue of 51.79 billion KZT (≈$114 million, up 9.53% from 47.28 billion KZT in 2024) [4].

Legal policy: Bayan Sulu's legal form is JSC- Joint Stock Company [2]. Ferrero's legal form is Ferrero International S.A, which is a Public Limited Company under Luxembourg law [5]. Since Ferrero operates globally, individual Ferrero subsidiaries can have different legal forms.

Customers: Bayan Sulu and Ferrero have similar customers because both sell confectionery products. Bayan Sulu mainly serves customers in Kazakhstan and nearby countries**,** including children, families, and people who enjoy sweets such as chocolate, biscuits, and candies. Ferrero has a much wider global customer base. Its products are popular among children, families, and adults in many countries. Ferrero focuses on well-known brands such as Nutella, Kinder, and Ferrero Rocher.

Technology/AI: Bayan Sulu uses modern production technologies to make confectionery products, including automated equipment and quality-control systems. It also uses digital technologies to improve production and business processes. Ferrero uses more advanced technologies, including automation, data analysis, digital systems, and AI in some business and production processes. AI can help Ferrero improve production, quality control, supply chains, and understand customer needs.

Economy: Bayan Sulu mainly sells its products through supermarkets, shops, distributors, and online platforms in Kazakhstan and other countries. Its products are affordable and aimed at a wide range of customers. Ferrero sells its products through supermarkets, retail stores, distributors, and online shopping platforms around the world. Its well-known brands are available in many countries, which helps the company reach a large global market. Both companies grew in their most recently reported year: Bayan Sulu's net income rose 28.41% to 4.44 billion KZT in 2025 [4], reflecting healthy profitability from its affordable, mass-market pricing, while Ferrero's 4.6% turnover growth points to continued demand for its premium, brand-led products [3].

Competitors: Bayan Sulu's main competitors are LOTTE Rakhat (formerly Rakhat, majority-owned by South Korea's Lotte Confectionery since 2013) [6] and other local confectionery companies in Kazakhstan. Ferrero competes with large international companies such as Mondelez, Mars, Nestlé, and Lindt. Ferrero has stronger competition in the global market because its products are sold in many countries. The scale of that competition is significant: Mondelez reported net revenue of $36.44 billion for fiscal year 2024 [7], Nestlé reported total sales of CHF 91.4 billion

for 2024 [8], and Lindt & Sprüngli reported total sales of CHF 5.92 billion for fiscal year 2025 [9]. Mars is privately held and does not publish detailed public financial reports, but it is widely regarded as being of a similar scale [10].

How we can enable AI

AI can help to solve possible problem of understanding customer demand and managing production efficiently. AI could analyze previous sales, seasonal demand, and customer preferences to predict which products will be more popular. This could help Bayan Sulu produce the right amount and reduce excess products.

Recommendations

Expand export markets gradually: Bayan Sulu currently exports to only 14 countries and around 40% of its output [2], compared with Ferrero's presence in over 170 markets [3]. Growing further in nearby CIS, Central Asian, and Gulf markets, where Bayan Sulu already has export activity, would be a lower-risk way to increase that share before pursuing more distant markets.

Pilot AI-driven demand forecasting: Ferrero USA has adopted an AI-based supply-chain platform (Alloy.ai) to improve demand forecasting and reduce overstock and stockouts [11]. Bayan Sulu could pilot a similar, smaller-scale forecasting tool to support the demand-prediction use case described above and reduce excess production.

Build a focused international brand portfolio: Ferrero's global reach rests on a small number of flagship brands (Nutella, Kinder, Ferrero Rocher) rather than its full product range. Bayan Sulu could concentrate export marketing on two or three flagship product lines to build recognition beyond Kazakhstan.

Pursue international quality certifications: Competing for shelf space against Mondelez, Nestlé, Lindt, and Ferrero in export markets will likely require additional international food-safety and quality certifications (e.g., ISO 22000, HACCP) and export-ready packaging and labeling.

Consider strategic partnerships: Bayan Sulu's closest local competitor, LOTTE Rakhat, gained access to regional distribution and capital after Lotte Confectionery (South Korea) acquired a majority stake in 2013 [6]. A similar strategic partnership or joint venture could give Bayan Sulu comparable resources for international expansion.

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